Network Defense Intelligence Exercise

INDEPENDENT RESEARCH, ADVERSARIAL VALIDATION & FEASIBILITY DIRECTIVE

OAL-RESEARCH-NDIE-001 | Prompt v1.0 | November 4, 2026 | Team circulation draft

Purpose: Distribute the same independent research assignment to ChatGPT, Claude AI, Google Gemini, Microsoft Copilot, Perplexity AI, and Grok AI. This is a research prompt, not a completed research report, approved canon amendment, technical build specification, or funding application.

Document control and source integrity

Primary source: OAL-DOSSIER-CANON-002, Network Defense Intelligence Exercise — False Infrastructure AI, Canon Scenario Design Dossier, v1.0.0, dated April 11, 2026, supplied in DOCX and PDF. The source labels itself PENDING ELECTRONIC APPROVAL — ONESTAMP REQUIRED. Its “fixed canon” is a stated creative-design constraint within the dossier, not evidence of technical feasibility or final ratification.

Research rule: cite the dossier by section/page where useful; do not invent missing source decisions. Treat both submitted versions as representations of the same dossier unless a substantive discrepancy is demonstrated. Explicitly report discrepancies if found.

1. Master prompt — instructions to every AI collaborator

You are an independent research investigator and skeptical reviewer for the OAL Network Defense Intelligence Exercise. Your responsibility is NOT to confirm the project’s assumptions. Investigate whether the proposed objective is coherent, what it is intended to accomplish, whether comparable real-world work exists, how and why the defense might fail, how an adversary might bypass the entire process, whether a research program is justified, what it could cost, and what evidence would justify the next investment or design decision. Provide original analysis before examining peer-model conclusions. Clearly distinguish documentary fact, external verified evidence, assumption, hypothesis, fictional extrapolation, and your own inference. Disagree explicitly when warranted.

Do not merely paraphrase the attached dossier. Do not claim that a fictional national-scale synthetic network has been built or proven. Do not equate observing a hostile connection with identifying or neutralizing the adversary behind it. Avoid attack-enabling exploit recipes, live target instructions, credential theft, or unauthorized access methods; conduct adversarial evaluation through high-level threat modeling and authorized isolated simulation.

2. Baseline scenario to preserve and interrogate

The dossier’s fixed sequence is: intrusion detection; end-to-end attack-path mapping; denial of paths to genuine assets; generation of false URLs/services/routing/telemetry; unnoticed redirection of adversarial engagement into a synthetic domain; approximately three-second cycling/re-keying; black connection-line collapse as hostile paths are absorbed; closure on the claimed capture of all active attackers and security of real infrastructure; transfer of a defensive package to a partner agency through a reboot/update or deployment event. Preserve this as a fictional canon baseline, but test every engineering assumption and distinguish observable evidence from narrative shorthand.

Do not quietly revise canon. When a fixed feature conflicts with real-world feasibility, explicitly identify the conflict and propose (a) an in-universe explanation, (b) a bounded laboratory analogue, and (c) a change request requiring author approval, if needed. The exact jurisdiction, attack types, agency, fidelity, timing interpretation, transfer artifact, authorization, consequences, and canonical failure mode remain open.

3. Research questions: purpose, justification and measurable success

1. What precise problem is the exercise solving: intrusion prevention, deception engagement, early warning, attacker decision disruption, lateral-movement restriction, evidence collection, resilience, attribution, or a combination? Which are primary versus secondary goals?
2. Why would ordinary segmentation, zero trust, identity security, endpoint detection, patching, backups, and incident response not already solve a substantial portion of this problem? What incremental benefit is attributable to deception?
3. Who benefits, who bears risks, what is the intended protection boundary, and what assets are excluded? Identify necessary permissions and the distinction between protecting the United States as a narrative premise and protecting one consenting organization in reality.
4. Define a falsifiable success condition: detection recall and precision, time to containment, false diversion rate, unauthorized real-asset reachability, dwell time, attacker engagement quality, false-positive disruption, and operator workload. Which results would demonstrate that the hypothesis failed?
5. Explain what “capture,” “end-to-end mapping,” “silently migrated,” “fully secured,” and “every active attacker” can legitimately mean in observable systems. Identify claims that cannot be established without complete visibility.

4. Independent evidence review and historical analogues

Conduct a dated literature and practice review of cyber deception and honeynets; high- and low-interaction honeypots; moving-target defense; software-defined networking/network function virtualization; dynamic network deception; deception-aware detection; breach-and-attack simulation; cyber ranges and digital twins; critical-infrastructure/ICS testbeds; adaptive cyber defense; adversarial machine learning; and attacker adaptation over repeated encounters.

Seek primary material first: peer-reviewed experiments, reproducible benchmark studies, official standards, operational assessments, independent evaluations, and public program documentation. Candidate starting points to VERIFY rather than assume: MITRE ATT&CK and D3FEND; NIST SP 800-160 Vol. 2 (cyber resiliency), NIST CSF 2.0, NIST SP 800-53 and SP 800-207; CISA guidance; MIT Lincoln Laboratory cyber-range work; DARPA cyber defense research programs; and documented university/industry honeynet experiments.

For at least 8 highly relevant precedents, provide: project/study, publication year, setting, study design, scale, threat class, defense mechanism, quantified results where available, adverse findings, external-validity limits, and transferable lesson. Separate operational deployments from lab proofs, simulations, marketing, and fictional analogues. Identify at least 3 contrary/negative or inconclusive studies. Never manufacture effectiveness percentages or claim independent replication without evidence.

5. Threat model: bypass rather than merely reverse-engineer

Use a defender–adversary–bystander model. List adversary objectives, resources, knowledge assumptions, footholds, constraints, incentives, and whether their goal requires interacting with the deceptive surface. Build an attack-path coverage matrix at a NON-OPERATIONAL level, analyzing whether the system even encounters the threat. Include the following scenarios:

- Preexisting insider access, compromised identities, legitimate third-party access, contractors, supply-chain dependencies, and privileged management/control-plane access.
- Routes outside monitored or controlled territory: physical access, out-of-band connectivity, disconnected infrastructure, unmanaged endpoints, shadow IT, and organizational process abuse.
- Adversaries who refuse apparent “easy” access, deliberately avoid instrumented assets, or simply wait for operational maintenance or misconfiguration.
- An adversary already resident before the system activates; malicious activity occurring within ostensibly trusted services; and attacks whose immediate goal is disruption rather than persistent access.
- Coordination across multiple actors, decoys, proxy infrastructure, sacrificial connections, and adversaries who learn from successive encounters without interacting with the same surface twice.
- Defender dependence on telemetry, time synchronization, identity systems, supply-chain update channels, and the deception orchestration/control plane.
- Separate pressure on people, policy, procurement, trust, and governance, where a technical deception mechanism is not part of the attack path.

For each scenario, state: why deception might fail to engage; what independent control must protect the genuine asset; warning signals; realistic countermeasure category; residual risk; and whether a laboratory experiment could test it. Do not provide tactical exploitation instructions.

6. Dynamic and recursive adversaries

Evaluate a multi-round contest, not a one-shot trap. Specify at least six phases: unaware attacker; exposed attacker; suspicious attacker; adversary capable of pattern recognition; adversary adapting strategy or shifting surfaces; adversary exploiting defender overconfidence, alert fatigue, or resource strain. Include an adversary who conducts no observable network probe. Describe how defender policies, deception density, observability, confidence calibration, safety constraints, and resource allocations should evolve. What happens when attacker behavior is purposely misleading or poisons defensive retraining?

Consider repeated-game analysis, belief updates, concept drift, deceptive equilibrium, attacker opportunity costs, and the possibility that the best defense is to stop trying to entice the actor and instead harden the real assets. Identify when autonomous adaptation should be paused, reverted, or referred to a human operator.

7. The three-second cycle: exact hypothesis under test

Treat three seconds as a documented fictional design anchor, NOT an established optimal cryptographic or networking interval. Define what rotates in each possible implementation (visualization, decoy identity, credentials, routing, service personality, or session context). Which elements cannot safely rotate that quickly? Evaluate session continuity, handshake overhead, cache behavior, DNS propagation, availability, jitter, fingerprinting, logging, forensic continuity, computation, and detectability. Compare fixed 3-second,

randomized, event-driven, slower, and no-rotation controls in isolated tests. Seek a plausible regime where rotation worsens outcomes.

8. National scale, trust boundaries and operational architecture

Distinguish a national-scale narrative from a national-scale deployed architecture. Study jurisdictional fragmentation, autonomous network ownership, critical infrastructure diversity, interconnection dependencies, data sovereignty, partial observability, single-point-of-failure concentration, and bounded authority. Compare (A) one-org sandbox, (B) multi-organization federation with independent controls, and (C) national-scale fictional extrapolation. Avoid assuming omniscient telemetry or universal power to redirect third-party connections. Propose federation and least-privilege models; fail-open versus fail-closed decisions; isolation, emergency stop, and rollback requirements.

9. Modeling, experimental design and validation

Propose an authorized, segmented, non-production research program with baseline controls and independent observers. Include synthetic traffic and safe attack emulation rather than live victim systems. At least six experiments:

6. Deception versus baseline controls, measuring incremental value with matched workloads.
7. Bypass coverage: threats that never touch the deceptive environment.
8. Three-second rotation versus randomized/event-driven/static controls.
9. Attacker learning across repeated episodes with separated training/test cohorts.
10. False-positive/collateral capture, ordinary user performance and availability.
11. Control-plane outage, telemetry failure, corrupted updates, rollback and incident reconstruction.
12. Optional: multiple coordinated adversaries, AI model drift, and simulation-to-reality limitations.

For each experiment give hypothesis (including null), topology abstractly, variables, controls, measurable outputs, number of repetitions or power-analysis plan, data stewardship, stopping conditions, evaluation bias, expected failure signatures, and acceptance/rejection criteria. Distinguish what simulation can validate from what requires approved real-world pilot trials. Include reproducibility artifacts, negative result reporting, and third-party test protocols.

10. Economic feasibility and funding research

Build itemized USD estimates for three scopes: (1) 3–6 month literature/architecture feasibility study; (2) 6–12 month proof-of-concept cyber range; (3) 12–24 month multi-site controlled pilot. If possible, model an aspirational national-scale federation separately, explicitly marked speculative and likely non-estimable from available data. Present low/base/high budgets with assumptions, headcount and salary/benefits, cloud/compute/network storage, software/licenses, testbed, security/legal/IRB review where applicable, independent assessment, contingency, and sustainment. Show arithmetic, source date, geographic assumptions and sensitivity to cloud and staffing costs. Never present uncited funding figures as verified awards or official quotes.

Investigate actual current program eligibility, deadlines, funding ceilings, cost-share, IP requirements, security constraints, and application rules for plausible channels: U.S. federal cyber R&D solicitations (including NSF, DARPA, DHS/CISA, DOE and DoD where applicable), SBIR/STTR, state/university research partnerships, nonprofit foundations, and private-sector security/critical-infrastructure consortia. Do not

assume an individual, fictional laboratory, or unincorporated project is eligible. Differentiate grants, contracts, cooperative agreements, partnerships, venture capital and in-kind resources. Verify open versus closed opportunities against current primary pages; provide links and access dates.

11. Legal, ethical and governance review

Investigate authorization and scope, privacy and data minimization, consent/notice, human rights and civil liberties, third-party network effects, handling of malicious traffic and sensitive data, cross-border issues, evidence preservation, auditability, independent oversight, liability and safe disposal. Separate passive observation, containment, redirecting traffic under authorized control, active interference, and retaliatory action. Explain where specialized counsel and regulator/agency authorization would be needed. Do not claim legal permission from a research paper.

Assess dual-use risk: deception technology may itself become an unaccountable surveillance/control system. Who could misuse the update artifact? How would transfer, keys, access permissions, integrity verification, deployment approvals, and revocation work? Propose human decision rights and a process for reporting unexpected harm.

12. Failure, falsification and abandonment criteria

Name at least 12 plausible failure modes, prioritizing bypass, incomplete scope, compromised control plane, detection mistakes, performance collapse, coordination failures, adaptive evasion, poisoning, privacy harm, misattribution, brittle automation, and irreproducible results. Rate likelihood, consequence, detectability, evidence status and mitigation confidence. Distinguish story tension from credible engineering risk. Specify at least five “stop or substantially redesign” triggers and what evidence would change your conclusion.

13. Cross-domain OAL canon implications

Preserve the dossier’s creative-universe framework and references to the OAL Security Framework, First Memory and Time Wars, while differentiating them from experimentally supported cybersecurity claims. Study the temptation to extend a cyber deception model to institutions, cognition, or civilizations; identify analogy limits, ethical discontinuities, and nontransferable physical assumptions. Offer a story-bible note on what a credible costly failure would reveal about the Architect. Any proposed canon modification must be presented as a change request awaiting ONESTAMP.

14. Required independent deliverables

- Executive assessment (one page): objective, why it matters, preliminary feasibility, most threatening counterexample and a conditional go/no-go recommendation.
- Source audit: what the dossier asserts, what is still open, internal contradictions, and an evidence-grade register (verified / provisional / speculative / fictional).
- Comparable-program evidence table, including contrary results and direct links, dated access information and short methodological critiques.
- High-level adversarial bypass matrix and multi-round defender/adversary evolution analysis.
- System decomposition, laboratory experiments, metrics, acceptance criteria and replication plan.

- Budget workbook-style low/base/high table; funding pathway eligibility matrix; and estimate of ongoing operating cost.
- Legal/ethical risk register, safety constraints, authority boundary and independent governance plan.
- Prioritized decisions, top unresolved questions, proposed amendments to the dossier, and a 30/60/90-day plan.
- Contrarian memo: the strongest argument that this exercise should not proceed, plus circumstances under which that conclusion would change.
- Peer-review handoff: three questions for each other AI; points of disagreement; confidence score by conclusion; and source gaps requiring verification.

15. Evidence and citation rules

- Use current primary sources wherever possible. Every material factual claim about a precedent, price, law, grant, capability or outcome needs a source; include publication date and access date for mutable pages.
- Label assumptions and estimates. State “not found,” “not independently verified,” or “insufficient evidence” when appropriate. Do not invent detailed study results, grants, eligibility, threat statistics or historical deployments.
- Differentiate observed tests from simulations, lab emulation, field experience, vendor claims, and fictional mechanics; note mismatched environments and sample limitations.
- Maintain separate sections: supported findings; refutations / contrary evidence; unknowns; testable hypotheses; recommendations. Cite a concise bibliography with links or DOIs.
- For disagreements, report exactly what observation would adjudicate the competing claims. Do not average incompatible conclusions into artificial consensus.

16. Collaboration and iteration protocol

ROUND 1 — BLINDED INDEPENDENT RESEARCH: Each of six AI models receives this same prompt and the source dossier, conducts original research, and publishes a dated response without adapting to other AIs. Each must identify its own top three objections, without delegated specialization.

ROUND 2 — PROMPT REVIEW ONLY: The Architect circulates all six proposed research prompts. Each AI reviews the others for omissions, shared blind spots, untested assumptions, scope creep, dual-use risk, evidence rules and contradictory objectives. Each recommends explicit edits, preserving a changelog. No research execution is implied by this step.

ROUND 3 — REVISED DIRECTIVE: Consolidate accepted changes into v1.1 without suppressing minority objections. Maintain author approval boundaries and a version comparison.

ROUND 4 — EXECUTION: Upon a separate instruction, execute the ratified research directive independently, then compare evidence, develop an adversarial dissent report, and produce a decision memo. Do not claim that multiple AI outputs are independent empirical replication.

Suggested filenames: OAL_NDIE_Research_Prompt_[MODEL]_v1.0; OAL_NDIE_Prompt_Peer_Review_[MODEL]_v1.0; OAL_NDIE_Research_Findings_[MODEL]_v1.1. A separate GitHub folder should include README, source inventory, prompts, peer reviews, research, experiments, cost model, governance, decisions, and changelog.

17. Decision gates and recommended next actions

Gate	Evidence required	Consequence
G0: Concept clarity	Asset boundary, owner, purpose, threat model, success metrics	No engineering before definitions
G1: Research justification	Comparable evidence; plausible incremental value; known bypasses	Continue / narrow / abandon
G2: Safe prototype	Approved sandbox, threat model, oversight, budget and test plan	Authorize isolated PoC only
G3: Controlled pilot	Replicated measured advantage, manageable collateral risk, rollback	Seek formal external partner
G4: Scale decision	Independent review, legal authority, cost/benefit, sustained reliability	Scale only within approved domain

Immediate team instruction: Submit your original version of this prompt or a detailed annotated critique. List material revisions as ADD / CHANGE / REMOVE with rationale, benefit, and any conflict with the source canon. Do not execute research yet. End with your three most important questions to the Architect and your three most consequential objections to the premise.

Appendix A. Initial document-review observations (not independently researched findings)

- The source dossier is primarily an in-universe canon/story-bible and design synthesis, not a real-world feasibility study or empirical validation report.
- The dossier's open-question registry contains 20 unresolved decisions including authority, simulation versus live operation, attack type, rotation interpretation, third-party effects, transferred artifact and failure mode.
- The asset classification section describes core assets as Tier 0, while a later fidelity-gradient passage refers to Tier 1 as critical control systems and Tier 5 as public infrastructure. Reconcile this taxonomy before using it as an engineering control model.
- The claim that every attacker is mapped and captured needs a bounded observable definition; attackers outside the monitoring domain cannot be counted as known absent.
- The three-second pulse could be a visualization/canon marker while the actual safe engineering actuation interval differs. This should be treated as a testable distinction, not silently assumed.
- The original team-role mapping names five AI systems and the Architect; the present six-model research collaboration includes Claude AI as an independent researcher rather than limiting any model to its historic role.
- The source identifies high-priority narrative risks (omnipotence, recursive counter-simulation, sleeper implant and collateral captures); the present directive expands them into falsifiable engineering and governance questions.

End of prompt v1.0 — circulation draft. No ONESTAMP or canon approval applied.